

SEO GROWTH PLATFORM · RUNNING COSTS

What It Costs to Run

A clear, simple breakdown of what you pay each month.

Every monthly cost to run AIOS for your ~15 clients — the server and the data — checked against live provider prices in July 2026. All figures are approximate and confirmed before you buy.

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DATE

9 July 2026

PRICING BASIS

Live provider rates,
July 2026

01 THE BIG PICTURE

Cost Is a Dial, Not a Fixed Bill

The most important thing to know about running AIOS: you decide what you spend. Free Google data does most of the everyday work. You only pay for extra data when a client is big enough to justify it. That is why a small client can run at almost nothing — and the whole setup stays cheap.

~\$110TYPICAL TOTAL PER
MONTH, ALL 15 CLIENTS**~\$7**AVERAGE COST PER
CLIENT / MONTH**\$0**LOWEST COST FOR A
STARTER CLIENT**2**THE ONLY THINGS YOU
PAY FOR: SERVER + DATA

Server & Infrastructure

A fixed, steady base: your own private server, the database, backups and a web address. About \$70–95/mo, no matter how many clients you have.

Live SEO Data

You pay only for what you use. Free Google data is always on; paid rank data from serper.dev runs at about ~\$30/mo for all 15 clients.

Already Covered — \$0

Google's free tools, the AI you already bought (Claude), and your in-house crawler all cost nothing extra here. They do the writing, analysis and audits.

THE ONE LEVER THAT CONTROLS EVERYTHING

Each client, and each feature, runs at one of three levels: **manual (free)**, **semi-automatic (low cost)**, or **fully automatic (paid data)**. Turn a client up only when their budget pays for it — and turn it back down any time. Nothing is locked in.

And your keys stay locked away — at no extra cost

Every password and API key — yours, your clients', and Google's — is kept in an encrypted key vault (Supabase Vault) that comes free with the plan already listed. The key that unlocks it is stored separately, so even a stolen copy of the database can't be read.

The Full Monthly Picture

Here is every monthly cost on one page, at normal usage for your ~15 clients on the recommended low-cost setup. Each line is explained in more detail on the following pages.

COST AREA	TYPICAL MONTHLY	WHAT IT COVERS
Server & infrastructure	~\$70-95	Private server, database, off-site backups, web address & security, email, monitoring.
Free Google data	\$0	Search Console & Analytics 4 — traffic, search terms, conversions, site health.
Rank data (serper.dev)	~\$30	Daily Google rank tracking for all 15 clients. Prepaid credits — no subscription.
Site audits & backlinks	\$0	Audits on your in-house crawler; backlink checks from Semrush/Ahrefs CSV exports.
Premium tools (Semrush / Ahrefs)	\$0 by default	Manual CSV import keeps these at zero. Switch a single client to live API only when needed.
Secure key vault	\$0	Encrypted in Supabase Vault (included above).
Typical total	~\$110/mo	~\$7 per client. Moves between ~\$95 (lean) and ~\$140 at heavy use.

Fixed vs. pay-per-use

Only the server line is truly fixed. The rank data is pay-per-use — it goes up or down with how many clients you turn on and how often you check rankings.

Two safety nets on spending

A monthly cap per client, plus an automatic daily stop on every paid service. A runaway job can never turn ~\$30 into a surprise bill.

A note on these numbers

Every figure is approximate and checked against live provider prices in July 2026. Final prices are confirmed before you buy, and you approve every paid service before it is switched on. Your Claude AI is already paid for, so it is not part of these running costs.

03

INFRASTRUCTURE

Server & Infrastructure

The fixed base that runs the whole platform and every client portal. You own all of it. This total stays about the same whether you have 5 clients or 15.

ITEM	PROVIDER & PLAN	APPROX. / MO	WHAT IT IS
Private server (VPS)	Hetzner Cloud — CPX31 (4 vCPU / 8 GB)	~\$42	Runs the platform, all client portals and background jobs. Price shown is the EU region.
Database, login & storage	Supabase Cloud — Pro	~\$25	Managed database, user logins, file storage and daily backups.
Off-site backups	Backblaze B2 (pay-as-you-go)	~\$1–6	A second copy of your data, kept off the server. First 10 GB free.
Domain & SSL	Registrar + Let's Encrypt	~\$2	Your main web address; security certificates renew free, automatically.
Automatic emails	Resend (free tier)	~\$0	Sends reports and alerts. Free up to 3,000 emails/mo; about \$20 if you send more.
Monitoring & alerts	Sentry · UptimeRobot · Netdata	\$0	Error tracking, uptime checks and server health — all free tiers.
Secure key vault	Supabase Vault (in Pro)	\$0	Encrypted safe for every API key & Google access. Built into Supabase — no extra cost.
Infrastructure subtotal		~\$70–95	Fixed monthly base, no matter how many clients you have.

SERVER REGION — A COST LEVER WORTH KNOWING

The server price above is Hetzner's **EU region (~\$42/mo)**, the best value. A **US-region** server costs more (~\$73/mo) after Hetzner's June 2026 price rise, and a smaller server costs less. We'll recommend the right size and region for you before you buy.

Prices exclude local VAT/tax and a small IPv4 address fee (~\$0.70/mo). Backups grow with your data — tiny at your size for the first year or two.

Live SEO Data (serper.dev)

This is the only pay-per-use line — and it stays small. Free Google data does the everyday work, your in-house crawler runs the audits, and serper.dev checks Google rankings for a tiny fraction of a cent each.

FREE DATA LAYER — ALWAYS ON, \$0

Google Search Console

Clicks, impressions, search terms & page performance. Free API.

Google Analytics 4

Traffic, channels and conversions per client. Free Data API.

In-house crawler & AI

Runs your site audits and the bulk, repetitive work on your own server at \$0 per use.

PAID DATA — SERPER.DEV, PAY-AS-YOU-GO (ALL 15 CLIENTS)

JOB	HOW OFTEN	SEARCHES / MONTH	APPROX. / MO
Rank tracking (page 1)	Daily	~22,500 searches	~\$22.50
Full-position scan (top 100)	Weekly	~3,200 searches	~\$6.50
serper.dev subtotal		~29,000 credits	~\$30

Why it's pennies, not seats

One rank check costs about \$0.001 (a tenth of a cent). Buying only the exact searches you need — instead of a fixed monthly seat — is what keeps all 15 clients near ~\$30.

Adjusted per client

Every job above can be turned off or slowed (daily → weekly) per client. Small clients run mostly on free Google data; only premium clients get the full daily refresh.

serper.dev is prepaid, not a subscription — a \$50 pack of 50,000 searches (valid 6 months) covers all 15 clients for roughly a month and a half. A full top-100 scan counts as 2 searches. Audits run on your in-house crawler (\$0) and backlink checks come from Semrush/Ahrefs CSV exports (\$0), so serper.dev is the only paid data line.

The AI Behind Your Dashboard

Your AIOS dashboard runs on Anthropic's Claude — the AI you already license. Because you own it, it is \$0 in your monthly running costs. This page is a plain reference to the models it uses and what each one does.

ALREADY LICENSED BY YOU — \$0 EXTRA PER MONTH

Claude runs on your own Anthropic account, so nothing on this page is added to your ~\$110/month running costs. **For context:** running the same work on a metered API — if you didn't already own it — would be roughly **~\$140–200/month**, so this is real value you already hold.

THE MODELS YOUR DASHBOARD RUNS ON (PRICE PER 1M TOKENS, ≈ ¾ MILLION WORDS)

MODEL	PRICE IN / OUT	CONTEXT	WHAT IT POWERS
Claude Haiku 4.5 BULK claude-haiku-4-5	~\$1 / ~\$5	200K	High-volume tidy-up, classification and data cleanup.
Claude Sonnet 5 WORKHORSE claude-sonnet-5	~\$3 / ~\$15 (intro ~\$2/~\$10 to Aug 2026)	1M	Audit analysis, on-page recommendations, report writing, content briefs.
Claude Opus 4.8 DEEP claude-opus-4-8	~\$5 / ~\$25	1M	Monthly strategy, competitor synthesis and the hardest reasoning.

WHERE IT SHOWS UP IN YOUR DASHBOARD

Audits & Reports

Sonnet 5 reads each technical audit and writes the client-facing report, findings and on-page fixes.

Strategy & Insights

Opus 4.8 produces the monthly strategy and competitor analysis — the deep thinking clients read first.

Behind the scenes

Haiku 4.5 handles the high-volume, repetitive tidy-up and classification — cheaply and fast.

Two built-in levers keep usage efficient even though it's already paid for — caching reuses shared prompt parts at about 90% off, and batching runs non-urgent jobs at half price. Model names, IDs and prices are current as of July 2026 and confirmed on your Anthropic account.

Two Ways to Run It

The same platform runs cheap or fully loaded — your choice, and you can change it any time. Almost the whole difference is premium tool subscriptions, which the platform lets you avoid by default.

RECOMMENDED

Low-Cost

~\$110 /mo

Free Google data + cheap serper.dev ranks + in-house audits + premium tools on manual CSV. Everything the clients see still refreshes automatically. ~\$7 per client.

MAXIMUM AUTOMATION

All-API

~\$500 /mo

Every data source live, including paid Semrush/Ahrefs seats. No manual export work at all. For when the whole book of clients pays for it. ~\$33 per client.

LINE-BY-LINE COMPARISON

LINE ITEM	LOW-COST	ALL-API
Server & infrastructure	~\$70–95	~\$70–95
Google (Search Console / GA4)	\$0	\$0
serper.dev (rank tracking)	~\$30	~\$45
Site audits & backlinks	\$0 — in-house + CSV	via Semrush/Ahrefs
Semrush + Ahrefs	\$0 — manual CSV	~\$250–500 — seats/API
Total / month	≈ \$110	≈ \$500
Per client / month	≈ \$7	≈ \$33

Where the ~\$390 gap comes from

Almost the entire difference is **Semrush/Ahrefs subscriptions**, not APIs. Because your team can export a CSV and drop it in — read exactly like the live feed — you only pay for those seats on the specific clients who justify it. AI (Claude) is already yours, so it is \$0 in both columns.

07 ALL-IN TOTAL

Everything Included — The All-In Monthly Total

The complete picture with nothing left out: every line added together, including the server (VPS) and the optional Fathom notetaker. Even fully loaded, all 15 clients run at about ~\$145/month.

TWO NUMBERS, KEPT CLEAR

Your **core running total is ~\$110/month**. This page adds one optional extra — the Fathom notetaker (~\$34/mo) — for a complete figure of **~\$145/month**. Claude and the key vault stay \$0 (you already own them); leave the notetaker off and you are back to ~\$110.

EVERY LINE ITEM — NOTHING EXCLUDED	APPROX. / MO
Server & infrastructure — VPS, database, backups, domain, email, monitoring	~\$70–95
serper.dev — rank data, all 15 clients	~\$30
Site audits, backlinks & premium tools — in-house crawler + Semrush/Ahrefs CSV	\$0
AI — Claude — already licensed by you	\$0
Secure key vault — Supabase Vault, all keys encrypted	\$0
Fathom AI notetaker — Business tier, API access	~\$34
All-in total — everything switched on	~\$145/mo
Per client / month	~\$10

Only three lines carry a charge

The server, serper.dev and the notetaker. Everything else is free or already owned (Claude).

If you metered the AI too

You don't need to — you own Claude. For reference only, metered AI would add ~\$140–200/mo, and live Semrush/Ahrefs seats up to ~\$250–500.

Assumptions, Add-Ons & Next Steps

WHAT THESE FIGURES ASSUME

- ~15 clients**, about 50 tracked keywords each, on the recommended low-cost setup.
- Daily rank tracking (serper.dev), weekly audits (in-house crawler) & backlink checks (CSV), monthly reports.
- Premium tools (Semrush/Ahrefs) left on **manual CSV import** — the \$0 default.
- All passwords & API keys held in an **encrypted key vault (Supabase Vault)** — included, no extra cost.
- All prices **approximate**, checked against live provider rates in **July 2026**.
- Figures exclude local tax/VAT and the one-time build & handover project.
- Claude AI is already yours** and is not counted here; **you approve every paid service** before it starts.

OPTIONAL ADD-ON (IN THE ALL-IN TOTAL, NOT THE CORE ~\$110)

ADD-ON	APPROX. / MO	WHAT IT ADDS
Fathom AI notetaker	~\$34 (~\$25 annual)	Turns discovery-call recordings into tailored proposals automatically. Needs Fathom's Business tier for API access. A Phase-2 feature you can add later.

NEXT STEPS

- 1

You confirm the setup
Low-cost to start, and which clients (if any) get premium data.
- 2

We set it up & you own it
Server and accounts created in your name; we hand over the keys.
- 3

Adjust spend per client
Start small; turn individual clients up as their budgets grow.
- 4

Spending stays visible
Live per-client cost tracking, caps, and the daily stop, always on.

AIOS · MONTHLY OPERATING COSTS

~\$110/month, ~\$7 per client — a dial you control, not a fixed bill.

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